UCLA School of Nursing

700 Tiverton Avenue
Factor Bldg, Box 956919
Los Angeles, CA 90095-691

February 5, 2026

Dear Awards Committee,

Marianne Gutierrez, RN, PhDc has taught, supported, and mentored hundreds of nursing students in various courses as a Teaching Assistant (TA). Registered Nurses (RNs) face harrowing challenges on the front lines. Therefore, what they learn here at UCLA is crucial to prepare them for their futures. Marianne's empathy for their path; her way of relating as a fellow health care professional, as a daughter of immigrants, and as a graduate student; combined with her firm grasp on crucial course content has made her an invaluable TA. Novice and advanced graduate students alike reported they gained from her approachable teaching style, top-notch student-centered designs (e.g., BruinLearn and other learning tools), and her commitment to listening to students ***first*** to tailor materials to meet their learning needs. Students found her relevant, inclusive, authentic, present, and inspiring due to her honesty and excellence. I have served as Marianne's professor, Dissertation Chair, and employer (she was a TA for two of my advanced qualitative methodology courses with doctoral students from Nursing, Social Welfare and Medicine and she was a bilingual-bicultural Research Assistant (RA) for a randomized controlled trial (RCT) I led, focused on connecting Spanish speaking Latinas with untreated depression or anxiety to needed care), which informs my assessment in this letter.

As the TA for two demanding, advanced level methodology courses, Marianne was an astute and valuable member of the teaching team. She was a careful listener and engaged mentor. She modeled excellence as she shared her own de-identified qualitative work in lectures and 1:1 meetings with students, spurring students to gain mastery. Marianne was devoted to identifying techniques for learning that students found approachable and acceptable; she tailored her teaching strategies based on open dialogue with students, trial and error, and best practices. As a qualitative researcher herself, Marianne listened with sensitivity and enthusiasm as students honed their research questions, inquiring meaningfully, with specificity, to each student, so they could refine their aims in ways that reflected ***their*** values and intentions. Students' research questions were challenging, often thorny or stigmatizing – questions that needed to be answered if nurses, social workers, and physicians were to make positive impact for underserved groups. Marianne knew each student would be most fulfilled if they answered questions that were compelling to them, as this would inspire them to reach higher. I saw students readily soaking up and integrating her lessons, seeking her out for 1:1 meetings. With mutual-respect and a non-judgmental approach, I saw Marianne in another teaching role, i.e., as a mentor to two undergraduate Latina nursing students on our RCT team. Taking them under her wing, Marianne used principles of active learning and fostered their ability to grasp how to conduct participant interviews and obtain rich qualitative data while being respectful of the autonomy and dignity of each participant. I saw first-hand that Marianne walked her talk. By consistently digging deeper with and for students, she has crafted an approach to teaching well worth honoring. For these reasons, I wholeheartedly endorse her for this Award.

Sincerely,

MaryAnn V. Heil

Professor, UCLA Joe C. Wen School of Nursing
Associate Program Director of the UCLA National Clinicians Scholar Program, Department of Internal Medicine, UCLA David Geffen School of Medicine

I have not won any formal teaching award, but I do feel a sense of accomplishment in helping nursing students at UCLA feel that they belong, they are capable, and to envision themselves not only as a registered nurse, but as nurse leader. I have been a teaching assistant at the Joe C. Wen School of Nursing and working with students at different points, helping students build a foundation and develop their physical assessment skills, or later as their build their clinical reasoning skills in Medical-Surgical courses, or in their last year when they take a nursing leadership or healthcare policy course. I have also supported students from other departments (e.g., education, social work, etc.) in graduate course (e.g., Advanced Qualitative Methods), all of which has strengthened my ability to teach students across different academic backgrounds and experience.

In their evaluations, students have repeatedly expressed how they felt comfortable asking questions and how readily available I was to meet with them. I understand that in addition to their coursework, students also have clinical rotations. Some of these clinical rotations are in the evening, or during the weekend, or take place during normal office hours. Additionally, I recognize how students may feel not only physically but emotionally drained from their clinical rotations. Equally important, I understand students may be balancing jobs, family responsibilities, sudden illness or loss. I have always offered flexible office hours, meeting students in the evening or during the weekend. I have always been proactive about reaching out to students, particularly if we notice a change in their participation in class, attendance, or submission of assignments. I drafted an email template and collaborated with faculty on how to tailor according to the student's needs or situation. Our mission is to act early, check in with students, offer support and resources.

A key component in nursing education is making unfamiliar and complex material feel less daunting through active teaching strategies. We do not want the students to memorize, rather we want them to be engaged, to think critically and be able to apply concepts to real world settings. We use case studies, share from our experiences working in healthcare to highlight nursing concepts and practices. I worked with lead faculty to create a Jeopardy-style review to help keep course content engaging, it also allowed them to practice applying concepts to scenarios that had a time limit. The actively also encouraged some lightness and laughter in what can be a stressful time as a nursing student, especially during midterms. In one of the final projects, we offered students alternatives to group presentations through non-traditional formats (e.g., podcast, social media video, scripted skit). Not only were students enthusiastic about these options, they were able to convey course content in a way that connected more deeply with their peers.

Inclusive and accessible teaching is another priority for me as an educator. At the first class session, after introducing myself, I advocate for the use of campus resources and services, such as the Center for Accessible Education (CAE). I work with lead faculty to destigmatize the use of these services and share how I have used these supports. I proactively reach out to CAE specialists and with students with accommodations to ensure their needs are met. For example, during the summer I worked closely with one of the CAE disability specialists to collaborate with the student and lead faculty to create a tailored plan on how to meet the requirements of the

course. I want students to feel that they belong, to reach out for help or support, to see all the opportunities that nursing holds for them (e.g., pursuing advanced certifications, degrees, research, advocacy), and the impact they can have on their communities.

Ultimately, I want to help build a strong, safe and ethical nursing workforce. I have shared my experiences as a nurse, not only at the bedside (e.g., hospital setting), but in community and legislative settings. I have shared near-misses, instances where a medical error almost became a reality, including when I was guilty of a near miss. Similarly, I have shared when I have advocated for patients at the bedside, or on the Hill with legislators advocating for patient rights and safe working conditions.

I am deeply honored and humbled to be nominated for this prestigious award. In reviewing student comments, reflecting on my experiences as a TA, I do see the impact I have had in student's lives and that is my greatest award.

As a daughter of immigrants, I have navigated two worlds: the cultural values and expectations I carry as a Latina woman, and the promise of the American I was taught to believe in school. Growing up in a low-income, multi-generational home, it was difficult to reconcile what an American life looked like on television and what my lived reality. What both worlds agreed on was the value of honest, hard work and that those who practice this will gain success. My mom would always tell my brother and I: "*Las cosas se hacen bien o no se hacen,"* which translates roughly into "Either do things right, or not at all." I have carried this throughout my academic and professional career, wanting my work to demonstrate quality and strong work ethic. However, I have also learned that hard work does not guarantee success or even access, recognition, opportunity, or inclusion in professional and academic spaces. This understanding has informed how I teach and interact with students. I am deeply committed to creating a learning environment that is inclusive, supportive, and engages students as collaborators.

As a teaching assistant (TA) in the Joe C. Wen School of Nursing department, our work is multi-layered because our students are not only faced with a heavy coursework load, they are immersed in a whole new world. I remember in nursing school in my first class my professor told us that we would experience a "culture shock" and that many of the students in our classroom would not be there at the end of our program. At the time, I thought she was referring to students not committing to the workload. Later, though, I understand what she meant: nursing students are required to step into a new culture with its own language and expectations. They are learning medical terminology, healthcare systems, strengthening their critical thinking and interpersonal skills. They are building the physicality of hands-on skills, providing life-saving measures and learning how to communicate effectively within clinical teams and with patients and their families.

As a TA, I see myself as a bridge, one that helps students make that transition from student to nurse leader. Simultaneously, while a bridge needs to be supportive, it also needs to be structurally sound. Regardless of where a student is in their nursing pre-licensure pathway, I work to help build or reinforce their clinical reasoning, assessment skills, advocacy for patient safety and better patient outcomes. Students need to be able to act swiftly when they notice signs and symptoms that are alarming, or a sudden change in patient condition, all while communicating and working with the healthcare team (e.g., medical doctor, respiratory therapist). Throughout my time as a TA, I have collaborated with leading faculty on mixed media assignments, hands-on activities, case studies, and other activities that help provide connection to real life experiences as a nurse.

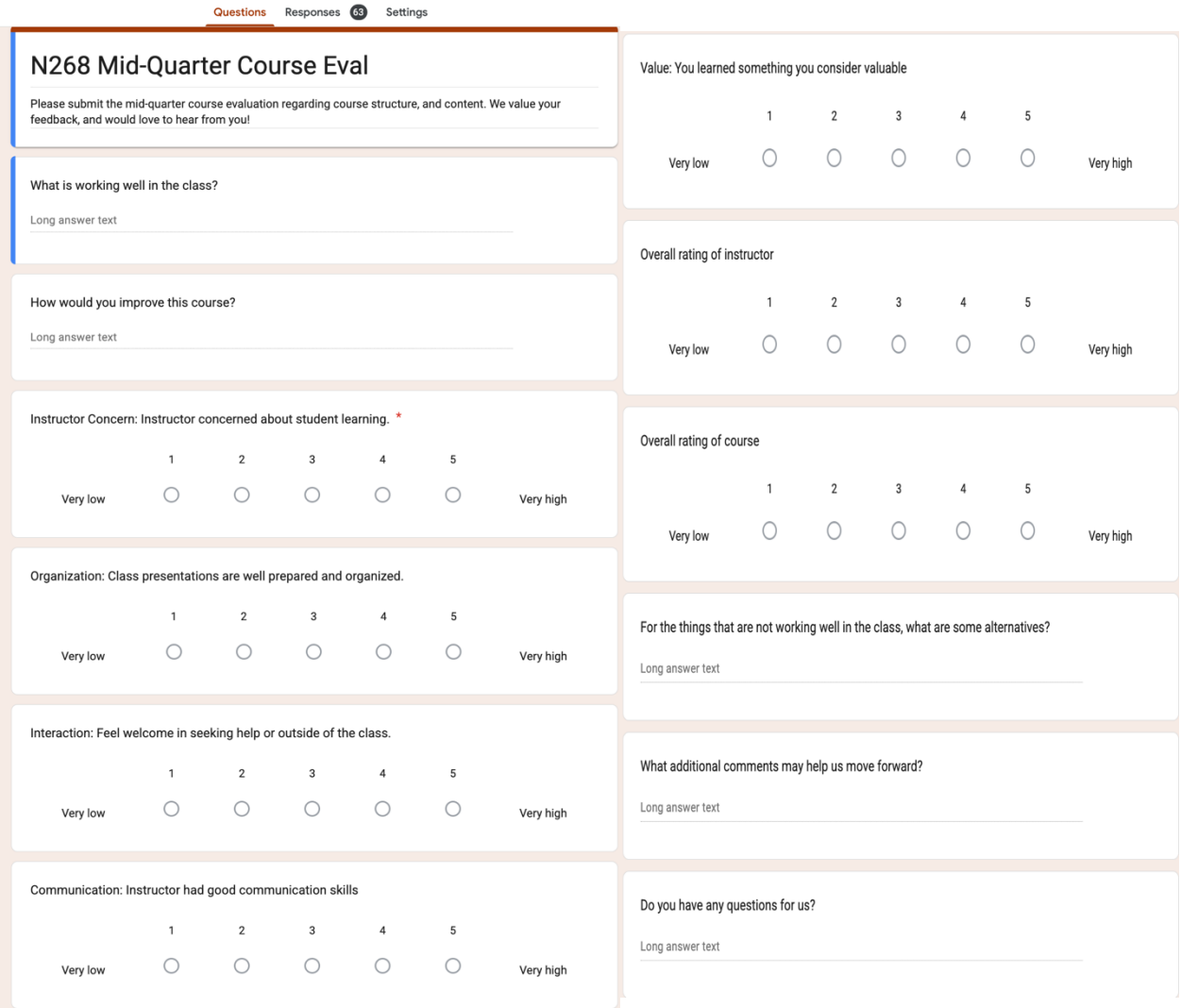
Unfortunately, in nursing there is a saying "nurses eat their young," which refers to a mindset some nurses may have in regard to new graduate nurses or inexperienced nurses. Nurses that experience this may feel isolated, excluded, bullied and/or be assigned heavier workloads. In each class that I have been a TA, I make it a point to state that this type of behavior should not be tolerated and that part of my job as a TA is to make them feel supported, included, and welcomed into the world of nursing.

I see my students as more than just my students, I see them as a future co-worker, colleague, or nurse that may someday be my nurse. My mission to help build their technical skills, their critical thinking, and also their confidence. They need confidence to take action when they notice a change in a patient condition, to voice when they note a medical error (and speak out regardless of who made the error), to care for someone who was labeled by another healthcare professional as "a difficult patient" and investigate further – perhaps the patient is apprehensive about their diagnosis, a new medication, or medical procedure and has refused care or raised their voice. However, as I have reminded my students, we need to dig a little deeper to understand what may be influencing the patient's behavior. I emphasize how we need to treat our patients how we would want our loved ones treated: with patience and empathy.

I apply an intersectional lens to how I see and interact with my students. I understand that student's learning is impacted by various social conditions and multiple identities they may occupy. Some students commute to school from long distances, or face heavy traffic to and from school and clinical rotation sites. Others may be first-generation college students working part-time, commuting, be single parents, or are returning to school after years working in another field and have decided to make a drastic change from their previous career. I take all of this into consideration as a TA. I understand that students need mentorship, skills to build connections, and make the hidden curriculum visible. I encourage students to join professional organizations, attending nursing conferences, volunteer and get involved in their community. At the same I understand that not all students have the capacity to do extra work outside of their course workload and clinical rotations. Early on I share campus resources (e.g., CAPS, CAE, Writing Center, Basic Needs Support) and other resources and opportunities that can help support their academic and professional growth (e.g., scholarships, leadership programs). I want students to feel that they belong, that they feel comfortable to ask questions, ask for additional support, accommodations or extensions. If they can advocate for themselves then I know they will be able to advocate for their patients and their communities.

In order to stay true to the teacher and mentor I want to be for my students, I collaborate closely with faculty, working as one cohesive team that prioritizes the learning experience of our students and future nursing workforce.

Artifact 1: Example of Mid-Course Evaluation Form. Screenshots are from the mid-course evaluation from for N258, Summer 2025.



Mid-Quarter course evaluations were conducted during Week 4 to elicit feedback from students and make adjustments accordingly.

Artifact 2: Screenshots from student evaluations/individual instructor reports.

Written comments from students in the student evaluations/individual instructor reports:

N174: Physical Assessment (undergraduate students; pre-licensure)

- Mariane was a knowledgeable and passionate TA who was always willing to assist students in any way possible. She would answer students' questions in a detailed manner throughout class and made sure that she was available for student questions and assistance during class and outside of class hours. She provided positive affirmation and encouraging words for students throughout the quarter which helped to boost the morale and confidence of students. She also incorporated her own nursing experiences and anecdotes in her guest lectures, which was extremely helpful.
- Marianne Gutierrez was a wonderful instructor who helped us really understand how we should approach hemodialysis as future nurses. She gave an amazing lecture about her experiences as a hemodialysis nurse and how we should assess these patients. She also uploaded a video on the types of hemodialysis, how we should assess and report, and also the precautions we need to take for these patients. Her lectures and videos really helped in understanding the material.
- Marianne gave great lectures during class and also provided tons of helpful supplemental information and material. Excellent communication inside and outside of class, and really went above and beyond to help us master the material!
- Marianne was a very helpful TA. She provided a very warm and welcoming learning environment for the students. I appreciate the time she set aside early in the morning for CAE students to take our weekly quiz. There were times where she presented topics and her lecture presentation were well organized, informative, and helpful. She looks out for students who have questions and interacts with them.
- Marianne was wonderful as a TA. I feel like she was so knowledgable and always had an important perspective on the material. She was also very encouraging, which helped make it through the quarter. Her lectures were very thorough and informative. For example, the hemodialysis lecture was really interesting and seems like it will be very helpful in the future.

  all our questions we had. Enjoyed how she would use her experience and expertise and give us examples that applied to the course material. Her lectures were organized, well paced, and gave examples to explain complex concepts. I really enjoyed the dialysis lecture, you explained everything incredibly well and professional. I enjoyed the images you drew, helped get the theory across. Very responsive via email and was a pleasure to have as a TA. She cared about our success and offered many ways to help us through the quarter.

N204 Research Design & Critique (graduate nursing students; licensed)

- Marianne is an outstanding TA. She is incredibly supportive and encouraging, especially when things did not always go according to plan throughout this course. She facilitated scholarly dialogue amongst students and provided us with a safe space to do so. I hope I get the opportunity to learn from her again in future courses.
- Marianne is inspiring, is a leader and is a very helpful TA with comprehensive info. She has valuable insight. She inspired me to pursue a doctorate degree.

N267: Healthcare Policy (graduate nursing students; pre-licensure)

Marianne was an amazing TA for this course. She was highly concerned with student learning and would always give amazing, thorough feedback on all of our assignments. In addition, she was incredibly responsive over emails, even replying when I had a question on the weekend. I appreciated her presence so much and highly recommend her as a TA.

- Marianne was wonderful throughout the quarter. She is always so encouraging and helpful. She responds to messages quickly. It was nice to start our MECN careers with her in physical assessment and end with her in policy.
- Ms. Gutierrez was an excellent TA who was always available for her students. She provided prompt feedback on questions asked. She led many meaningful discussions during this course. Excellent work.

N205C: Advanced Qualitative Methodology II (graduate students; interdisciplinary)

- Feedback on assignments was very thoughtful and thorough. Marianne was evidently very knowledgable about the subject material and willing to meet with students for office hours. She also expressed genuine concern for student well-being when personal issues came up. Overall a great TA and would love to take another course with her.
- Marianne gave detailed, nuanced, and impactful feedback on all my student work in a timely way. Her feedback was instrumental for my growth in the course and in this new skillset. I know there was a lot of work required "behind the scenes" for this course in terms of organizing the assignments, posting many resources and readings, and giving feedback on student work, but Marianne made it look easy.

N54A: Pathophysiology

- It seemed like the TA really cared, when I didn't do very well on a midterm she immediately reached out to me to see if there was anything she could help me with, she showed me resources I could use and went over the exam with me, usually TA's are available but don't reach out to you directly so that was very nice.
- Marianne was a great TA and really cared about our learning. Although we didn't have sections for this course, she showed up to every class to assist the instructor with technology issues and answered questions. In addition, she made herself available for office hours weekly. She was very knowledgeable and welcoming in office hours and I did not feel intimidated at all asking for help. Overall, I really enjoyed having Marianne as our TA!
- Marianne was very fun as a TA. she always made herself available for students outside of office hours and was always willing to answer any questions. I really appreciate her dedication to the course as Pathophysiology is a very difficult class, but I REALLY appreciated her support and guidance for this class.
- The teaching assistant consistently displayed a high level of enthusiasm and passion for the subject matter, creating a positive learning environment and motivating students.
- This class covers a lot of materials, with only 1 hour and 20 mins in the class to cover a massive amount of information in the lecture is not enough. Thankfully, I always attended Office hours to review the class lecture. Marienne was very helpful, she explained to me all questions I had and went over the midterm questions that I did wrong, and I could understand my mistake. I am glad to be able to have office hours with TA. She is even willing to meet up virtually despite my busy schedule. Thank you for your work and help for the students.

N268: Leadership in Health Care Systems (graduate students; pre-licensure)

- Marianne was the one of the best TAs I've had at the school of nursing. She was always willing to stay late to give us more knowledge and insight. She responded quickly to every email to ensure we were successful in the course, and it was clear the level of detail she put in to help us understand the material and perform better in our assignments. I am so grateful for her, her compassion and understanding, while helping us be the best students we could be. I hope she will continue to be a TA, and her efforts recognized because we were all lucky as students to have her.
- Marianne has been an outstanding teaching assistant to our nursing leadership course, demonstrating exceptional skill and dedication in her role. Her teaching and advice are both engaging and insightful, providing clear and comprehensive explanations that greatly enhance our understanding of leadership concepts. She offers invaluable professional advice, and their accessibility in-person and Zoom for questions and support has been a tremendous help in navigating the course material. Marianne's commitment to our professional growth is evident, and her contributions have significantly impacted our development as future nurses.
- Marianne was very helpful and encouraging when it came to nursing career and professional portfolio questions! Despite her busy schedule, I appreciate that she went into depth with all of my concerns and questions during her office hours. She also is great at connecting us to resources we think might be beneficial to our career. She is very supportive and makes it clear that she is always available to help students outside of class time!

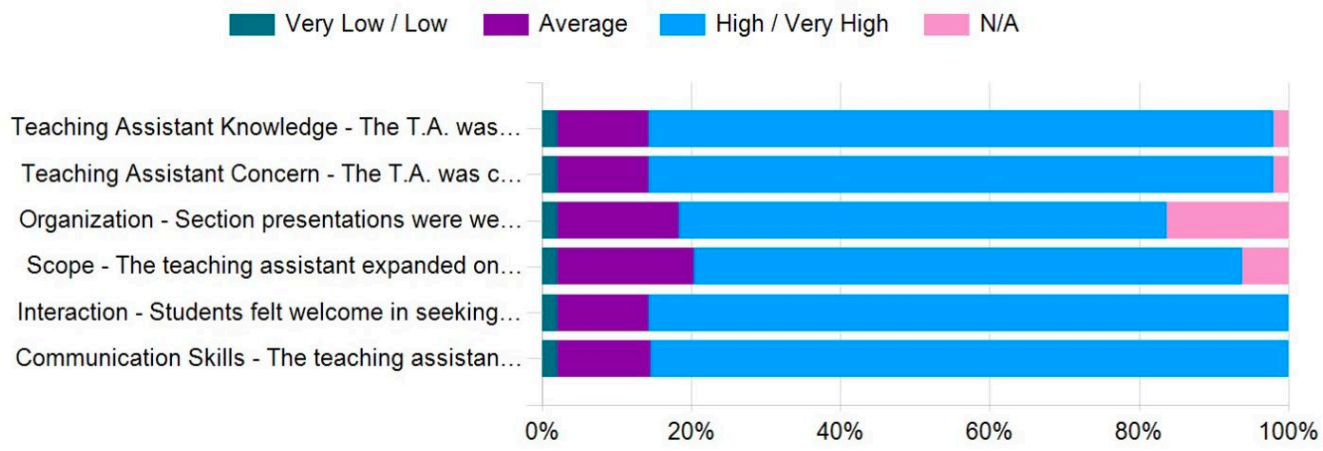
M. Gutierrez was really supportive and respectful. I felt like questions were always welcomed and a respectful learning environment was fostered. Overall, I enjoyed all that was learned.

Very thoughtful TA who consistently made herself available to answer any questions both in and out of the classroom. Knowledgeable about course material and cared about student success.

Marianne as a TA was a great addition to this course. She was very knowledgeable on this field and she always shared her insight with the rest of the class while Professor Jaime–Lara taught the course. Marianne has very strong communication skills and she was very supportive of our environment. I appreciated having her as a TA and I would defiitely recommend her for any future courses.

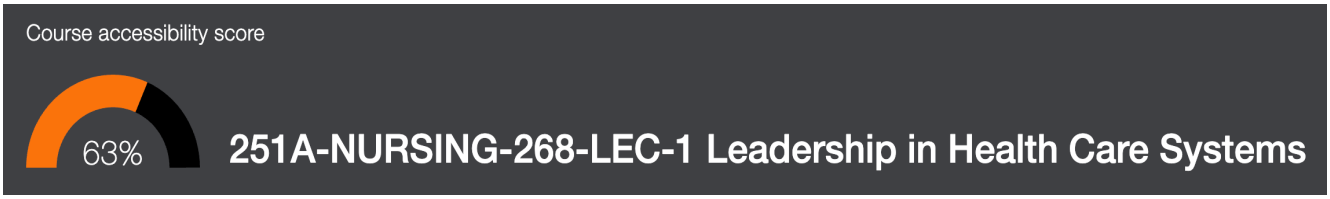
She was always present for us to answer questions and was extremely helpful during one–on–one office hours.
She is always available, knowledgeable, and helps us. She is supportive and student focused.

TA “To what extent do you…” graph (Individual instructor Report N268; Summer 2025).

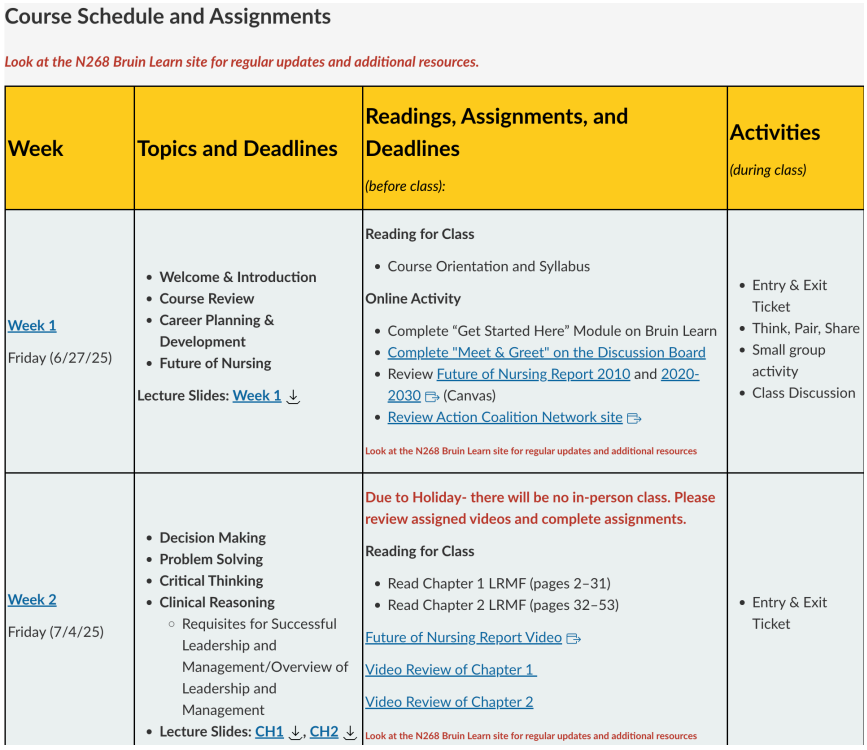


Artifact 3: Commitment to creating an inclusive environment that meets the needs of students and working towards increasing accessibility.

Ally Course Accesibility Report for N268 Leadership in Health Care Systems; Summer 2025: 63% score of the N268 Bruin Learn site.



N268 Course "Home" Page on Bruin Learn Screenshot. The home page included links to each week's module and included links throughout the the home page. Activites planned for each class meeting included hands-on activities, including group activities, discussion, and use of engaging game-like activities to help support class materials.



Course Schedule and Assignments

Look at the N268 Bruin Learn site for regular updates and additional resources.

Week	Topics and Deadlines	Readings, Assignments, and Deadlines *(before class):*	Activities *(during class)*
Week 1 Friday (6/27/25)	• Welcome & Introduction • Course Review • Career Planning & Development • Future of Nursing Lecture Slides: Week 1	Reading for Class • Course Orientation and Syllabus Online Activity • Complete "Get Started Here" Module on Bruin Learn • Complete "Meet & Greet" on the Discussion Board • Review Future of Nursing Report 2010 and 2020-2030 (Canvas) • Review Action Coalition Network site Look at the N268 Bruin Learn site for regular updates and additional resources	• Entry & Exit Ticket • Think, Pair, Share • Small group activity • Class Discussion
Week 2 Friday (7/4/25)	• Decision Making • Problem Solving • Critical Thinking • Clinical Reasoning ◦ Requisites for Successful Leadership and Management/Overview of Leadership and Management • Lecture Slides: CH1, CH2	Due to Holiday- there will be no in-person class. Please review assigned videos and complete assignments. Reading for Class • Read Chapter 1 LRMF (pages 2–31) • Read Chapter 2 LRMF (pages 32–53) Future of Nursing Report Video Video Review of Chapter 1 Video Review of Chapter 2 Look at the N268 Bruin Learn site for regular updates and additional resources	• Entry & Exit Ticket

Example of "Jeopardy" format to review exams, key concepts in N54A (Pathophysiology) and N268 (Leadership in Health Care Systems).



Example of email sent to students with CAE Accomodations to acknowledge, verify, and extend additional support to students.

MARIANNE GUTIERREZ <mguti160@g.ucla.edu> Tue, Jun 25, 2024, 8:16 PM

to [redacted] Rosario

Hi [redacted]

This is Marianne Gutierrez, your TA for N268. I am writing to confirm that Dr. Jaime-Lara and I have received your CAE accommodation Letter. We have reviewed your letter and understand that you have been approved for the following accommodations:

- Distraction-Reduced Exam Environment
- 50% extra time
- Dependent Notetaking Support

We would like to schedule a meeting to discuss your CAE Accommodation Letter (after class, in person, or via ZOOM). We want to ensure we meet your learning needs and understand how to best support your learning experience in this class.

We look forward to meeting with you.

Kind regards,

Marianne

Marianne Gutierrez, PhD(c), MSN, RN
UCLA School of Nursing
Pronouns: she, her, hers
mguti160@g.ucla.edu
Please note: I am sending this message to you at a time that suits me. I do not expect you to read, reply, or take action outside of your regular working hours or schedule. Thank you!

Example of email sent to students with missing assignments, absences, or drop in scores, or outstanding circumstances (e.g., family emergency). I created a draft template, which Dr. Rosario Jaime-Lara and I then individualized according to each student situation.

N54: Office Hours Available Inbox × N54 ×

MARIANNE GUTIERREZ <mguti160@g.ucla.edu> Thu, May 4, 2023, 9:20 AM

to [redacted], Rosario

Good morning [redacted]

This is Marianne, your N54 Pathophysiology TA. I wanted to reach out to check in with you and let you know that Dr. Jaime-Lara and I are available. Please feel free to reach out if you would like to meet to review the exam one on one, review study skills, test-taking techniques, etc, or if there is anything else I can do at this time to help support you.

If so, let me or Dr. Jaime-Lara know and we can set up a time. We can meet over ZOOM or talk over the phone, whichever you prefer. Your success in this class is very important to Dr. Jaime-Lara and me.

If I can be of help to you please do let me know!

Warm regards,

Marianne

Email from former undergraduate student regarding their experience in N54: Pathophysiology.

A [redacted] (Student Nurse) [redacted]ucla.edu> Mon, Jun 12, 2023, 8:27 PM

to Rosario, me

Hi Dr. Jaime-Lara and Marianne,

I apologize for the delayed response, as I didn't check my SON email within the last few days. I greatly appreciate you reaching out to me before the final exam, I wish I would have seen this sooner.

I want to thank you for the amazing past ten weeks of having you and Marianne as instructors for N54. I intended to reach out to you directly much earlier to talk about your impact on me this quarter. From our first lecture, I was inclined to share with you how excited I was to have you as my first Latina instructor here at UCLA, much more so within the School of Nursing. Unfortunately, the quarter flew by, and I was constantly busy. I felt infinitely empowered by both you and Marianne.

I am a first-generation student, coming from parents who immigrated here from [redacted]. I have struggled to adapt to the rigor at UCLA as I have maintained a part-time campus job while being a full-time student. However, Marianne and you provided a beautiful environment for me this quarter and showed genuine concern for my success. I wanted to express my gratitude to both of you. I have never had instructors as genuine as you both. I enjoyed learning the material for this class and loved its structure. I was swamped this quarter with 3 other prerequisite classes, but I wish I had worked harder in this class. Nonetheless, it was a pleasure to take your course this quarter, and I hope to reconnect with you in the near future. You have both inspired me to continue my career as Latina in the nursing field.

Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation

This award celebrates Teaching Assistants who demonstrate a pattern of effective teaching that incorporates current best practices (e.g., student-centered learning, active learning, inclusive teaching), aims to inspire and challenge students, and supports the success of all students.

Name

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)

Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation

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UCLA School of Nursing

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Phone: 310.206.2470
Rjaime-lara@mednet.ucla.edu
Rjaime-lara@sonnet.ucla.edu

January 31, 2026

RE: Letter of Support for Marianne Gutierrez

Dear Awards Committee:

It is with great pleasure and enthusiasm that I recommend Marianne Gutierrez for the Distinguished Teaching Assistant (TA) Award. I am an assistant professor at the UCLA School of Nursing. I I have worked with Marianne for three years and she is an exceptional TA. She was instrumental to my success as an instructor and has always been deeply committed to student success.

As a TA, Marianne was instrumental to my success as an instructor. For example, in the first course we taught in the Spring of 2023, she initiated a conversation with me about instituting midterm evaluations to garner student feedback to improve the course. Since that Spring, she has helped me create and review mid-term evaluations. Those evaluations have been instrumental in guiding our efforts to improve the courses. We have used the feedback we received to make changes to the course, and quarter evaluations have reflected that the students appreciated and welcomed these changes.

She responsibly assisted me in preparing material and establishing course curriculum. For example, she helped me create online jeopardy games every year and to think of ways to engage student learning. When challenges arose, she communicated with me and we troubleshooted technological, conceptual, and nursing student conflicts effectively, patiently, and creatively. She also assisted me in assessing and improving assignment descriptions and BruinLearn grading rubrics to support student success. One of the qualities that impressed me the most, was how proactive Marianne was in the face of challenges. She took the initiative to support and set up meetings with students and me as soon as she noticed their grades lagged or decreased. She proactively and confidently brought up and helped me manage students' needs and concerns.

Another of Marianne's standout qualities is her genuine concern for student well-being, learning and success. She consistently went above and beyond to

accommodate students and provide a positive and inclusive learning environment. Marianne was able to communicate with students from various backgrounds in a way that addressed their diverse learning styles and needs. Students described Marianne in their evaluation as attentive, supportive, and readily making herself available to address their questions and concerns. Throughout her time as my teaching assistant, she consistently demonstrated exceptional initiative, organizational and communication skills, maturity, and dedication. These qualities will equip Marianne to succeed as a future doctorally prepared nursing educator and researcher. She is and will continue to be instrumental in helping educate and empower the next generation of nurses.

Lastly, Marianne is a first-generation student and has used her story to encourage and support students. Her experience and perspectives also provide her with a unique research lens to study and support Latinx communities. Furthermore, Latinx nurses are greatly underrepresented among nursing faculty, this scholarship can support Marianne in completing her PhD and thus increase diversity and Latinx presence among future nursing faculty.

In summary, I would like to express my utmost support for Marianne. I strongly believe she is a great candidate for the Distinguished Teaching Assistant Award.

Sincerely,

Rosario B. Jaime-Lara

Rosario B. Jaime-Lara, PhD, RN
Assistant Professor, UCLA School of Nursing
700 Tiverton Dr. Rm 5-232
Los Angeles CA 90095
Office: 310-206-2470| Cell: 510-789-9814